



Vendor · Canonical Shape Directory

Reference · v1.0

The 2-segment vendor identity — minimal by doctrine. $\text{PAY_SEQ} \times \text{IDENTITY}$. Brand scope and sells categories are computed from the RM ring at query time.

SECTION 1

The minimal vendor identity

The vendor canonical code carries only what's mathematically necessary: **PAY_SEQ** (the architectural cash-flow binary) and **IDENTITY** (the unique abbreviation). Everything else — which BRANDs they supply, what they SELL — is a **computed view** derived from the RM ring at query time.

This obeys the COA Doctrine: properties that can be derived from upstream entity rings are never duplicated as static fields. A vendor that stops supplying NCH automatically loses its NCH scope; no manual sync required.

TOTAL VENDORS

0

live in editor

PAY-FIRST (PF)

0

cash leaves first

RECEIVE-FIRST (RF)

0

goods arrive first

LINKED VS ORPHAN

0 linked · 0 orphan

RM-referenced vendors

[↗ Vendor Editor](#)

[↗ RM Editor](#)

[↗ RM Shape Directory](#)

[↗ COA Doctrine](#)

[↓ Live Census](#)

SECTION 2

Code Anatomy — 2 segments, left to right

{PAY_SEQ} - {IDENTITY}

PAY_SEQ

POSITION 1 · 2 CHARS · THE ARCHITECTURAL BINARY

Pf = pay-first (cash leaves before goods arrive) · **Rf** = receive-first (goods arrive before money goes out).

2 values · Pf · Rf

IDENTITY

POSITION 2 · 3-10 CHARS UPPERCASE

Unique abbreviation drawn from the vendor name. Auto-derived (consonants vowel-stripped); owner-overrideable. Globally unique across all vendors.

PRABHU · ZEPTO · SHARIFF · RENT · INTERNET

Reading order: PAY_SEQ tells the system the cash-flow direction. IDENTITY tells the system who the vendor is. That's it. Brand scope, sells categories, RMs supplied — all computed from the upstream RM ring.

SECTION 3

PAY_SEQ directory Position 1 · 2 chars

The architectural binary that classifies every vendor by cash-flow direction.

CODE	MEANING	REAL EXAMPLES
Pf	Pay-first. Money leaves our account before goods/service arrives. Quick commerce apps, prepaid subscriptions, advance rent, prepaid utilities.	Pf-ZEPT0 · Pf-RENT · Pf-INTERNET
Rf	Receive-first. Goods/service arrives before money goes out. Daily milk, departmental stores with credit terms, post-paid utilities, monthly bills.	Rf-PRABHU · Rf- SHARIFF · Rf- ELECTRICITY

Why a binary, not a 6-letter V-shape?

The richer V-shapes (V1a / V1b / V2 / V3 / V4 / V5) capture the precise cash-flow choreography of a single purchase event. Those live at the *action layer* and modulate per-purchase, per-supplier within a single vendor record. PAY_SEQ at the vendor level only captures the dominant direction — that's enough for the entity ring; the action ring fills in the granularity.

SECTION 4

IDENTITY directory Position 2 · 3-10 chars

A 3-10 character uppercase abbreviation that gives the vendor its identity within the global vendor namespace.

Length

3 to 10 characters, uppercase A-Z and 0-9 only. Codes need to stay scannable.

Source

Auto-derived from vendor name (consonants, vowels stripped, deduplicated). Owner override allowed.

Uniqueness

Globally unique across ALL vendors regardless of PAY_SEQ. Rf-PRABHU blocks Pf-PRABHU.

Case

Always uppercase. Editor and API normalise lowercase on save.

Sample derivations

VENDOR NAME	AUTO-DERIVED IDENTITY	NOTES
Prabhu Buffalo Milk Vendor	PRABHU	Lead noun retained
Zepto	ZEPTO	Brand name as-is
Shariff Departmental Store	SHARIFF	Lead noun
Rent — Hamza HKP	RENT	Functional handle
BESCOM (Electricity)	ELECTRICITY	Function over brand
BSNL Internet	INTERNET	Function over brand

When two vendors play the same operational role (e.g. two electricity providers across outlets), use a discriminator suffix — Rf-ELECTRICITYNCH, Rf-ELECTRICITYHE.

SECTION 5

Forbidden Combinations

Every anomaly the system rejects, in one place. The math literally cannot represent these.

FORBIDDEN	WHY CAUGHT	RESULT
<code>PAY_SEQ</code> outside {Pf, Rf}	The architectural binary is exhaustive — any third value would require a doctrine change.	
<code>IDENTITY</code> empty	Identity required.	
<code>IDENTITY</code> < 3 chars	Codes need to stay readable.	
<code>IDENTITY</code> > 10 chars	Codes need to stay scannable.	
<code>IDENTITY</code> collision	Two vendors cannot share the same identity, even across <code>PAY_SEQ</code> tiers.	
Lowercase / non-alphanumeric	<code>IDENTITY</code> is uppercase A-Z and 0-9 only.	
<code>DELETE</code> while RM-referenced	Cannot orphan an RM's supplier link silently — caller must remove from RM tree first.	

SECTION 6

Live Vendor Census — All Vendors Today

Fetches live from `/api/vendors`. Each vendor shows its computed scope (BRAND set) and sells categories (L=Loose / B=Branded / I=In-house). Click any code to open the editor.

No vendors yet. Open the [Vendor Editor](#) and click + Add New Vendor to begin populating the ring.

SECTION 7

Worked Examples — Reading codes left to right

Six real codes, each walked through one segment at a time.

1 · Rf-PRABHU — Loose milk vendor

Rf-PRABHU | ⊥ PRABHU – identity (loose buffalo milk vendor in Shivajinagar)
⊥ Rf – Receive-first (delivers milk daily; settled weekly/monthly)

Reads as: "A receive-first vendor named PRABHU." The computed view fills in: scope = NCH (only NCH consumes buffalo milk), sells = L (loose layer of NCH-AM-P-Lb-MLK).

2 · Pf-ZEPTO — Quick commerce app

Pf-ZEPTO | ⊥ ZEPTO – identity (the quick commerce platform) ⊥ Pf – Pay-first (you pay in app, then goods arrive in 10 minutes)

Reads as: "A pay-first vendor named ZEPTO." Computed: scope = HN (cross-brand — both NCH and HE order from Zepto); sells = B (branded SKUs only — Zepto doesn't deal in loose).

3 · Rf-SHARIFF — Departmental store with credit terms

Rf-SHARIFF | ⊥ SHARIFF – identity (Shivajinagar departmental store) ⊥ Rf – Receive-first (we collect goods, settle monthly bill)

Reads as: "A receive-first vendor named SHARIFF." Computed: scope = HN (cross-brand); sells = L + B (loose AND branded — they stock both formats).

4 · Pf-RENT — Landlord, advance rent

Pf-RENT | ⊥ RENT – identity (landlord – functional handle, not personal name) ⊥ Pf – Pay-first (rent paid 1st of every month, in advance for that month)

Reads as: "A pay-first vendor named RENT." Computed: scope is empty for now (rent isn't an RM purchase — it's an opex line). The RM ring won't list this vendor; that's fine — orphan vendors are valid for non-RM expense relationships.

5 · Rf-ELECTRICITY — Post-consumption utility

Rf-ELECTRICITY | ⊥ ELECTRICITY – identity (BESCOM, the Bangalore electricity board) ⊥ Rf – Receive-first (you consume electricity, then

get the monthly bill)

Reads as: "A receive-first vendor named ELECTRICITY." Like rent — orphan in the RM sense, but real for opex tracking. PAY_SEQ correctly classifies it as receive-first (post-consumption billing).

6 · Pf-INTERNET — Subscription, advance payment

Pf-INTERNET | ⊥ INTERNET – identity (BSNL or whichever ISP) ⊥—— Pf –
Pay-first (monthly fee paid in advance for the next billing period)

Reads as: "A pay-first vendor named INTERNET." Distinguishes itself from Rf-ELECTRICITY precisely because subscriptions reverse the cash-flow direction — that's the value PAY_SEQ adds.

SECTION 8

Why minimal · the doctrine

An obvious instinct would be to encode BRAND scope (NCH/HE/HN) directly in the vendor code: **Rf-NCH-PRABHU**. We deliberately don't, because:

BRAND is a relationship, not an identity. It changes when the RM ring changes — without any vendor mutation. Encoding it statically would create sync drift the day NCH stops using PRABHU.

SELLS is even more derived. Whether a vendor sells Loose or Branded depends on which RM layer their record sits in. That answer comes from the RM ring, not the vendor row.

PAY_SEQ is the only static fact. Whether you pay before or after receiving is a property of the vendor's commercial structure — it doesn't change based on which RM you bought.

So the canonical code carries only PAY_SEQ + IDENTITY. The richer view — what scope, what sells, which RMs — is computed at query time via ?

`include=relationships`, by walking `rm_sourcing_profiles.data_json` for vendor refs. Ledger-style: the entity is the immutable kernel; properties bloom from the relationships.

In the static row

- vendor_code (Pf/Rf-IDENTITY)
- pay_seq, identity_abbr, vendor_name
- communication / location / payment / GST in data_json

Never in the static row

- BRAND scope
- SELLS categories
- RMs supplied
- V-shape (lives at action layer)

SECTION 9

Connection to the RM ring + Action layer

The vendor ring is the **second entity ring**, sitting alongside the RM ring. Both feed downstream into the Action ring (purchases, productions, transfers).

Composition of an Action code (sketch)

`{ACTION}-{RM_CODE}-{VENDOR_CODE}-{V_SHAPE}-{TXN_ID}`

Examples:

PUR-NCH-AM-P-Lb-MLK-Rf-PRABHU-V1a-2026050801	← daily milk receipt
PUR-HN-AM-P-BL-BTR-Pf-ZEPT0-V3-2026050802	← Amul butter via Ze
EXP-OPEX-Pf-RENT-V5-2026050801	← monthly rent payment

RM ring

Five segments — what was bought. Vendor refs live inside data_json at the L / B / I layers.

Vendor ring (this page)

Two segments — who supplied + cash-flow direction. Computed views fill in scope/sells via the RM ring.

Action ring

Composes RM + Vendor + V-shape into a transactional code that an Event can aggregate. Defined in COA Doctrine.

Two entity rings, one action ring, one event ring. Every action code is a coordinate; every event aggregates actions. The vendor ring stays minimal so the action ring stays composable.